

VERNACULAR SOCIAL PLATFORMS IN NUMBERS

India's digital audience is predominantly vernacular, with 870 million users accessing the internet in Indic languages as of 2024 – 98 percent of all internet users – driving the demand for regional social platforms. ShareChat, India's leading vernacular network, boasts 180 million monthly active users across 15 languages, underlining the massive appetite for regional content. Short-video consumption dominates these platforms: on ShareChat, over 80 percent of content engagement comes from video posts, with Gen Z and millennials constituting more than 70 percent of active users.

Hyperlocal community apps also shine, with Public App reaching 70 million monthly active users – making it a prime destination for citizen journalism and local updates in small towns. Lokal, focused on regional news, classifieds, and jobs, has crossed 40 million users by mid-2025, reflecting its strong foothold in non-metro markets. Emerging platforms like Shuru are

gaining momentum too: the Indore-based hyperlocal app recently secured ₹29 crore in funding to expand its community engagement features.

In the lifestyle segment, Trell's web traffic surged to 76.75 million monthly visits in January 2025, showcasing the pull of video-led shopping and travel stories in regional languages. Meanwhile, Moj surpassed 300 million cumulative downloads following its explosive first-year growth – cementing its status as India's go-to TikTok alternative.

Overall, with 491 million social media identities in India (33.7 percent penetration) and 806 million internet users (55.3 percent penetration), regional social and messaging apps are not niche anymore – they're the mainstream drivers of India's digital social fabric. This robust vernacular ecosystem provides fertile ground for creators and communities to flourish in their native tongues, marking a decisive shift from global platforms to local innovations.

2. **Permissions:** Grant access to camera, microphone, and storage when prompted.
3. **Language Selection:** Choose your preferred UI and content languages from the 8 regional options (including Hindi, Bengali, Gujarati).
4. **Profile Creation:** Register using your mobile number or email, set up a profile name, and select a profile photo.

Creating viral short videos

- **Recording:** Tap the “+” button, hold to record, or tap to record segments (15–60 seconds total).
- **Effects & Filters:** Browse dozens of AR filters, beauty modes, and slow-motion effects in the Effects tab.
- **Music & Sounds:** Tap Music to select from trending tracks, regional folk songs, or Moj's royalty-free library.
- **Editing:** Use trim, merge, and text overlay tools to polish your clip. Tap Next to add captions, hashtags, and stickers.
- **Publishing:** Hit Post to share publicly – or select Friends Only for private sharing with followers.
- **Challenges & Duets:** Participate in hashtag challenges (e.g., #MonsoonMagic) or duet with another creator's video by tapping Duet beneath their post.

By engaging with trending challenges and leveraging Moj's robust editing suite, creators can rapidly build audiences – some users reaching millions of views within days.

3. Chingari – Reward-driven creativity

Chingari distinguishes itself by rewarding creators with its

native cryptocurrency token, \$GARI, offering an innovative monetization model that attracted over 50 million downloads by mid-2025.

App setup and wallet integration

1. **Download Chingari:** Available on Play Store and App Store; tap Install.
2. **Sign Up:** Use your mobile number for OTP verification.
3. **Link Crypto Wallet:** Navigate to Profile → Gari Wallet, follow the prompts to create or import an Ethereum-compatible wallet.
4. **Complete KYC (Optional):** For higher withdrawal limits, submit an Aadhaar-linked KYC in Settings.

